

BOOST WINDOWS STARTUP

The launch of Windows 8 has had mixed reactions from the masses. While its snazzy layout and almost instinctive UI gives it a fresh feel, it occasionally handles like a clunky-yet-sleek muscle car in comparison to the light sports model that Windows 7 is. But alas, one must move with the times. Peer pressure, and all that.

One USP of Windows 8 is the faster boot time. However, unlike perfection, this operating system could use a few tweaks to improve the PC's start-up time. To avoid this, the recommended step would be to rely on hibernate; Much like tablets and smartphones (A bar that Win8 seems to be aiming for). However, if you're a user who prefers to shut down your computer for a fresh start every day, here are some steps you can take to improve your start-up time. Most of these techniques can also be used in Windows 7.



Do a clean boot

It would be helpful to note that the Windows startup programs utility in Windows 8 has been shifted to the Task Manager. Open the task manager and move to the Startup tab. Then, just deselect the apps you don't need when Windows starts. For Windows 7 users, access the System Configuration menu [Windows +



Windows' new Startup tab



Boost Windows startup.....55

Optimise your gaming experience.....56

Increase your internet potency58

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R, type msconfig] to access these options.



Disable animations

If you're not too attached to the smooth transitions and effects in your Windows interface, use the Windows + X shortcut and select the System menu. In the System window, click on Advanced System Settings on the left pane and access the Performance Settings in the Advanced tab. Disable effects that you consider irrelevant. Disabling Aero in Windows 7 by switching to Classic Mode helps. Windows 8 users have the High Contrast option.

Disabling your Start screen and password also helps boost your start-up time. Access the User Accounts Menu [Windows + R, type *netplwiz*] and uncheck the 'users must enter a username and password' option.



Windows registry tweak

There are certain Windows processes that slow down your start-up. A simple win-

Type this into notepad, and save it as *speedystartup.reg*; Run the file and restart your system.



The software solution

There are several simple download-and-use software options online. *Soluto* is a very usable option to do an overall systems check on your laptop to see the errors on your unit. You can use it to find out the applications that hinder your performance. This will help you when you follow-up with Anvi Startup Booster.

Anvi Startup Booster is probably the most convenient, user-friendly one around. Being a 12MB file, it's easy on the download as well as light on the system. On startup, it shows you your current start-up time, and recommends changes



Soluto – A new way to do IT

dows registry tweak takes care of them:

```
[HKEY_CURRENT_USER\Control
Panel\Desktop]
"AutoEndTasks"="1"
"HungAppTimeout"="1000"
"MenuShowDelay"="8"
"WaitToKillAppTi-
meout"="2000"
"LowLevelHooks-
Timeout"="1000"
[HKEY_CURRENT_USER\Control
Panel\Mouse]
"MouseHoverTime"="8"
[HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE\SYSTEM-
CurrentControlSet\Control]
"WaitToKillService-
Timeout"="2000"
```

that could be made to lower it, a few notches. The plus-point of Anvi is that it has an easy restore option, in case you disable any program you weren't meant to. It's simple, effective and good for people who are uncomfortable with technology.



Manage fonts

Since the dawn of the digital era, Windows has slowed down boot time by loading fonts at startup. This is, admittedly, less of a problem than it used to be, but it can still slow you down. Chances are, you actually use very few of the available fonts. The best way to deal with